Java Junior Developer Assessment

Medium Level • OOP, Exceptions, Collections, equals() & hashCode()
60 Multiple-Choice Questions • Time: 90 minutes

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Score: _____ / 60 **Duration:** 90 minutes

Instructions: Circle or write the letter of the single best answer for each question. Each question is worth 1 point (60 points total). No partial credit.

Section 1: Object-Oriented Programming (OOP)

1. Which OOP principle allows a subclass to provide a specific implementation of a method already defined in its superclass?

A. Encapsulation
B. Overriding (Polymorphism)
C. Overloading
D. Abstraction

2. What is the main purpose of encapsulation in Java?

A. To allow multiple inheritance
B. To hide internal state and require all interaction through an object's methods
C. To speed up compilation
D. To allow static methods only

3. Which keyword is used to prevent a class from being subclassed?

A. static
B. final
C. private
D. abstract

4. Which of the following best describes method overloading?

A. Same method name, same parameters, different return type
B. Same method name, different parameter list, in the same class
C. Same method signature in a subclass
D. Different method names, same parameters

5. What does the 'this' keyword refer to inside an instance method?

A. The superclass instance
B. The current class definition
C. The current object instance
D. A static reference to the class

6. Which statement about abstract classes is TRUE?

A. They can be instantiated directly
B. They can contain both abstract and concrete methods
C. They cannot have constructors
D. They cannot have instance fields

7. What is the key difference between an interface and an abstract class in modern Java (8+)?

A. Interfaces cannot have any method bodies at all
B. A class can implement multiple interfaces but extend only one class
C. Abstract classes support multiple inheritance of state
D. Interfaces can have constructors

8. Which access modifier makes a member accessible only within its own class?

A. protected
B. public
C. private
D. default (package-private)

9. What is polymorphism in Java primarily used for?

A. Reducing memory usage of primitive types
B. Allowing one interface/reference type to be used for different underlying object types
C. Making variables immutable
D. Preventing inheritance

10. In the statement `Animal a = new Dog();`, which type determines which overridden method is called at runtime?

A. The compile-time (reference) type, Animal
B. The runtime (actual object) type, Dog
C. Neither, it causes a compile error
D. It depends on the variable name

11. What happens if a subclass does not override an abstract method inherited from its superclass?

A. Nothing, it compiles fine
B. The subclass must also be declared abstract, or it fails to compile
C. Java provides a default empty implementation automatically
D. It throws a runtime exception

12. Which of these is NOT one of the four core OOP pillars?

A. Inheritance
B. Polymorphism
C. Compilation
D. Encapsulation

13. What is 'composition' in OOP design?

A. Building a class by including instances of other classes as fields ('has-a' relationship)
B. Extending a class using inheritance
C. Overloading constructors
D. Casting an object to its superclass type

14. Which keyword allows a class to inherit from another class in Java?

A. implements
B. extends
C. inherits
D. super

15. What is the purpose of a constructor in Java?

A. To destroy an object
B. To initialize a newly created object
C. To override a method
D. To define static utility methods

16. Given `interface Shape { double area(); }`, which is TRUE for a class implementing Shape?

A. It may leave area() unimplemented if declared abstract
B. It must implement area() unless the class itself is abstract
C. It cannot have additional methods
D. It cannot be extended further

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Section 2: Exceptions

17. What is the superclass of all exceptions and errors in Java?

A. Exception
B. RuntimeException
C. Throwable
D. Error

18. Which of the following is a checked exception?

A. NullPointerException
B. ArrayIndexOutOfBoundsException
C. IOException
D. ArithmeticException

19. What must a method do if it can throw a checked exception and does not handle it?

A. Nothing special is required
B. Declare it using the 'throws' clause
C. Catch it silently
D. Convert it to an unchecked exception automatically

20. Which block always executes whether or not an exception is thrown (barring JVM exit)?

A. catch
B. try
C. finally
D. throw

21. What is the correct syntax to manually throw an exception?

A. throw new IllegalArgumentException("bad value");
B. throws new IllegalArgumentException();
C. raise IllegalArgumentException();
D. throw IllegalArgumentException;

22. Which of these is an unchecked exception (subclass of RuntimeException)?

A. SQLException
B. FileNotFoundException
C. NullPointerException
D. InterruptedException

23. What is exception chaining used for?

A. Preserving the original cause while wrapping it in a new exception type
B. Running multiple catch blocks in parallel
C. Improving loop performance
D. Disabling stack traces

24. In a try-with-resources statement, what requirement must the resource class satisfy?

A. It must implement Serializable
B. It must implement AutoCloseable (or Closeable)
C. It must be declared final
D. It must throw a checked exception in its constructor

25. What happens if a finally block contains a return statement?

A. It is ignored by the compiler
B. It can override/suppress a return or exception from the try/catch block
C. It causes a compile-time error always
D. It only runs if no exception occurred

26. Which statement about multi-catch (`catch (IOException | SQLException e)`) is TRUE?

A. The caught exception types must not be related by subclassing to each other
B. It is invalid Java syntax
C. It only works with unchecked exceptions
D. It requires each type to have the exact same superclass method signatures

27. What is a custom exception typically created by?

A. Overriding the JVM's Throwable class directly
B. Extending Exception or RuntimeException
C. Implementing the Error interface
D. Annotating a class with @Exception

28. What does 'exception propagation' mean?

A. An exception being logged twice
B. An unhandled exception moving up the call stack to the caller
C. Converting an exception to a warning
D. Catching the same exception in multiple catch blocks

29. Which best practice should generally be avoided when catching exceptions?

A. Catching specific exception types
B. Logging the exception with context
C. Catching generic Exception (or Throwable) and silently ignoring it
D. Using try-with-resources for closeable resources

30. What is the output behavior if an exception is thrown inside a catch block?

A. It is automatically suppressed
B. It propagates up unless handled by an enclosing try/catch or a following finally rethrows differently
C. The JVM ignores it
D. The original exception is re-thrown instead

31. Which of the following correctly describes 'Error' (e.g., OutOfMemoryError) in Java?

A. It should always be caught and recovered from in business logic
B. It represents serious problems that applications typically should not try to catch
C. It is a checked exception
D. It extends RuntimeException

32. What does the following code print?

```
public class Test {
public static void main(String[] args) {
try {
System.out.print("A");
throw new RuntimeException();
} catch (RuntimeException e) {
System.out.print("B");
} finally {
System.out.print("C");
}
}
}
```

A. A
B. AB
C. ABC
D. AC

Section 3: Collections Framework

33. Which interface does NOT extend Collection?

A. List
B. Set
C. Map
D. Queue

34. Which List implementation provides fast random access via index?

A. LinkedList
B. ArrayList
C. TreeSet
D. HashSet

35. Which Set implementation maintains elements in their natural sorted order?

A. HashSet
B. LinkedHashSet
C. TreeSet
D. ArraySet

36. What is the key characteristic of a HashSet regarding element order?

A. It preserves insertion order
B. It does not guarantee any specific iteration order
C. It sorts elements automatically
D. It allows duplicate elements

37. Which Map implementation preserves insertion order of its entries?

A. HashMap
B. TreeMap
C. LinkedHashMap
D. Hashtable

38. What does `List.of(1, 2, 3)` return?

A. A mutable ArrayList
B. An immutable list that throws UnsupportedOperationException on modification
C. A LinkedList
D. A null reference

39. Which of the following is true about ArrayList vs LinkedList for frequent insertions/removals in the middle of a large list?

A. ArrayList is generally faster because it uses contiguous memory
B. LinkedList is generally faster because it avoids shifting elements
C. They perform identically in all cases
D. Neither supports insertion in the middle

40. What exception is thrown when you try to modify a list while iterating over it with a standard iterator (without using iterator.remove())?

A. NoSuchElementException
B. ConcurrentModificationException
C. UnsupportedOperationException
D. IllegalStateException

41. Which interface provides key-value pair storage in Java Collections?

A. List
B. Set
C. Map
D. Queue

42. What does `Collections.unmodifiableList(list)` do?

A. Creates a deep copy that is sorted
B. Wraps the list so that structural modification attempts throw UnsupportedOperationException
C. Removes duplicates from the list
D. Makes the list thread-safe

43. Which data structure would you choose for a FIFO (first-in-first-out) processing order?

A. Stack
B. Queue
C. TreeSet
D. HashMap

44. What is the time complexity of retrieving a value by key from a well-implemented HashMap, on average?

A. O(n)
B. O(log n)
C. O(1)
D. O(n log n)

45. Which method is used to iterate over all entries of a Map?

A. map.values() only
B. map.entrySet()
C. map.keys()
D. map.iterator()

46. What happens when you put a key that already exists into a HashMap?

A. A DuplicateKeyException is thrown
B. The old value is replaced with the new value
C. Both values are stored under that key
D. The put operation is silently ignored

47. Which Collection type does NOT allow duplicate elements?

A. List
B. Set
C. Queue
D. ArrayList

48. What is the purpose of generics (e.g., `List`) in Java Collections?

A. To improve runtime performance of loops
B. To provide compile-time type safety and avoid explicit casting
C. To allow storing multiple types in the same list safely
D. To make collections synchronized

Section 4: equals() and hashCode()

49. What is the general contract requirement between equals() and hashCode()?

A. They are unrelated and can be implemented independently
B. If two objects are equal according to equals(), they must have the same hashCode()
C. If two objects have the same hashCode(), they must be equal
D. hashCode() must always return a unique value for every object

50. What is the default implementation of equals() inherited from Object?

A. Compares field values
B. Compares reference (memory address) equality, same as ==
C. Always returns true
D. Compares hashCode() values only

51. Why is it important to override hashCode() when you override equals()?

A. It is only a style convention with no functional impact
B. To keep the class Serializable
C. To ensure the class works correctly with hash-based collections like HashMap and HashSet
D. To make the class immutable

52. If two objects are NOT equal according to equals(), what does the contract say about their hashCode() values?

A. They must be different
B. They are not required to be different (they may or may not collide)
C. They must always be equal
D. hashCode() cannot be called on unequal objects

53. What problem can occur if you override equals() but forget to override hashCode()?

A. A compile-time error occurs
B. Objects that are equal() may end up in different hash buckets, breaking HashSet/HashMap lookups
C. The JVM automatically generates a correct hashCode()
D. equals() will stop working entirely

54. Which of these is a required property of equals() according to its contract? (choose the best answer)

A. It must be reflexive, symmetric, transitive, and consistent
B. It must always return true for objects of the same class
C. It must throw an exception when compared with null
D. It must compare only primitive fields

55. What should `x.equals(null)` return for any non-null object x, according to the contract?

A. true
B. false
C. It should throw a NullPointerException
D. It is undefined behavior

56. In a typical IDE-generated equals() method for a class with an int field 'age' and a String field 'name', what is usually checked first?

A. Only field values, without any reference or type check
B. Reference equality (this == obj) and null/class checks, then field comparisons
C. Only the hashCode() of both objects
D. Only the class name as a String

57. Why is using mutable fields in hashCode()/equals() risky when the object is used as a HashMap key?

A. It is not risky at all
B. If the field changes after insertion, the object may become unfindable in the map
C. It will cause a compile-time error
D. HashMap automatically re-hashes on every access

58. Which utility class provides helper methods like `Objects.equals(a, b)` and `Objects.hash(a, b, c)`?

A. java.lang.Object
B. java.util.Objects
C. java.lang.Class
D. java.util.Arrays

59. What does `Objects.equals(a, b)` handle gracefully compared to calling `a.equals(b)` directly?

A. Nothing extra, they behave identically in all cases
B. It safely handles the case where 'a' is null, avoiding a NullPointerException
C. It ignores type mismatches
D. It always returns true if either is null

60. If a class does not override equals() and hashCode(), what is used when it's placed as a key in a HashMap?

A. A compile-time error occurs
B. The inherited Object identity-based equals() and hashCode(), based on reference/memory identity
C. Java throws a runtime exception automatically
D. All objects are treated as equal

Answer Key

Q#	Answer	Q#	Answer	Q#	Answer	Q#	Answer
1	B	16	B	31	B	46	B
2	B	17	C	32	C	47	B
3	B	18	C	33	C	48	B
4	B	19	B	34	B	49	B
5	C	20	C	35	C	50	B
6	B	21	A	36	B	51	C
7	B	22	C	37	C	52	B
8	C	23	A	38	B	53	B
9	B	24	B	39	B	54	A
10	B	25	B	40	B	55	B
11	B	26	A	41	C	56	B
12	C	27	B	42	B	57	B
13	A	28	B	43	B	58	B
14	B	29	C	44	C	59	B
15	B	30	B	45	B	60	B